

Weekly Challenge 04: Pumping Lemma

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Definition 1. Let $G = (V, E)$ be a graph. A Coloring of G is a color assignment to vertices of G such that no two adjacent vertices has the same color. More formally, a coloring is a function $C : V \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ such that $\forall v, u \in V, \{u, v\} \in E \implies c(v) \neq c(u)$.

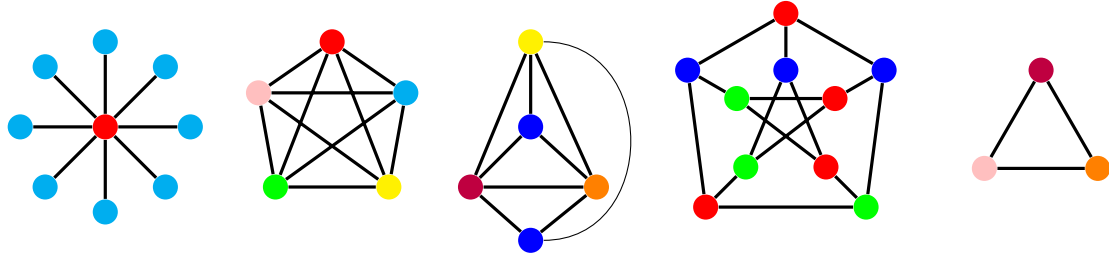


Figure 1: Some graphs with their vertex colored.

1. During your time at Habib you have studied graphs in various courses. Along with that you have studied various representations of graphs. One representations that is widely used is the adjacency matrix representation. In your previous CS courses you have encountered flattening a matrix, that is representing a matrix in $\mathbb{R}^{n \times m}$ as a vector in $\mathbb{R}^{nm}$.

Graph coloring is important computational problem with various applications such as scheduling some events without conflict and register allocation in compilers. Sometimes we are interested in finding if a certain graph can be colored with some k number of colors a famous such problem is asking if a graph can be colored with three colors.

Now each finite graph G can be represented as a string $w \in \{0, 1\}^*$ where w is the flattened adjacency matrix representation of G . In theoretical computer science we use the word “computational problem”(decision problem) and “language” synonymously. So the problem of deciding if a given graph can be colored with three colors can naturally be expressed as a language as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} 3 - \text{COLORING} &= \{w \in \{0, 1\}^* \mid w \text{ is a adjacency matrix representation of a graph} \\ &\quad G = (V, E) \text{ and } G \text{ can be colored with three colors}\} \end{aligned}$$

For example if the instance is asking if K_3 can be colored with 3 colors then w can be: $w = 011101110$. Where w represents a flattened adjacency matrix of K_3 .

Prove or disprove the following claim: 3 – COLORING is a regular language.

Solution: If $w \in 3 - \text{COLORING}$ then w is a flattened adjacency matrix of a graph $G = (V, E)$, so $|w| = |V|^2$. Therefore, if $w \in 3 - \text{COLORING}$ then $|w|$ is a perfect square.

Lets consider that $3 - \text{COLORING}$ is regular. By the Pumping Lemma there is a pumping length $p \geq 1$ such that every $s \in 3 - \text{COLORING}$ with $|s| \geq p$ can be written as $s = xyz$ which satisfies the considition:

1. $|xy| \leq p$,
2. $|y| \geq 1$,
3. $xy^iz \in 3 - \text{COLORING}$ for all $i \geq 0$.

Let $n = p + 1$ and let G_n be the graph on n vertices with no edges. It can be colored with one color, so its adjacency matrix is the all-zero matrix and its flattening is

$$s = 0^{n^2} \in 3 - \text{COLORING}, \quad |s| = n^2 \geq p.$$

Let $s = xyz$ be a decomposition which satisfies Pumping Lemma conditions (1) and (2), and write $k = |y|$. Then $1 \leq k \leq |xy| \leq p < n$.

the pumped string xy^2z . Its length is $n^2 + k$. Since $1 \leq k < n < 2n + 1$,

$$n^2 < n^2 + k < n^2 + 2n + 1 = (n + 1)^2$$

So $|xy^2z|$ lies between two squares and is not a perfect square, Therefore $xy^2z \notin 3 - \text{COLORING}$.

Since no valid decomposition exists, and the pumping lemma fails, $3 - \text{COLORING}$ is not regular.